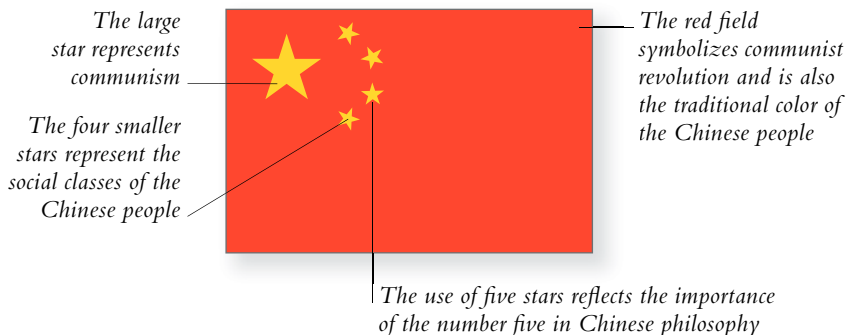


# China

**Ratio:** 2:3 **Adopted:** October 1, 1949 **Usage:** National and Civil



Asia



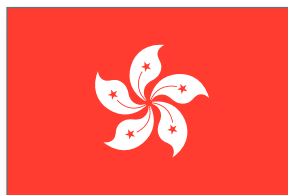
**China** has the world's oldest continuous civilization. The communist Chinese People's Republic was established in 1949.

China's first national flag originated in 1872. It was yellow with a blue dragon, representing the Manchu (Qing) Dynasty which ruled China for many years. The revolt of 1911 saw the changing of the flag to five different colored stripes. Soviet republics were established in the 1920s, each of which was represented by a red flag referring

to the Soviet fatherland. The present flag dates from 1949, when the People's Republic was formed.

The large star represents communism. The red field signifies revolution and echoes the ancient Han Dynasty of 206 BC. The four stars represent the four social classes: peasants, workers, petty bourgeoisie, and patriotic capitalists.

## FLAG OF HONG KONG (XIANGGANG) IN 1997



## FLAG OF MACAO IN 1999

